

NETWORK INVESTIGATION REPORT

AgentTesla FTP Exfiltration – Phase 2 Investigation

Organization:	Globex Manufacturing Ltd
Incident Reference:	INC-2024-1204-001
Analyst:	Michael Leramo
Role:	SOC Analyst Tier 2
Date of Incident:	4 December 2024
Report Date:	31 May 2026
Evidence File:	2024-12-04-AgentTesla-variant-using-FTP.pcap
Analysis Tool:	Wireshark
Classification:	CONFIDENTIAL
Severity:	HIGH

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1. Executive Summary

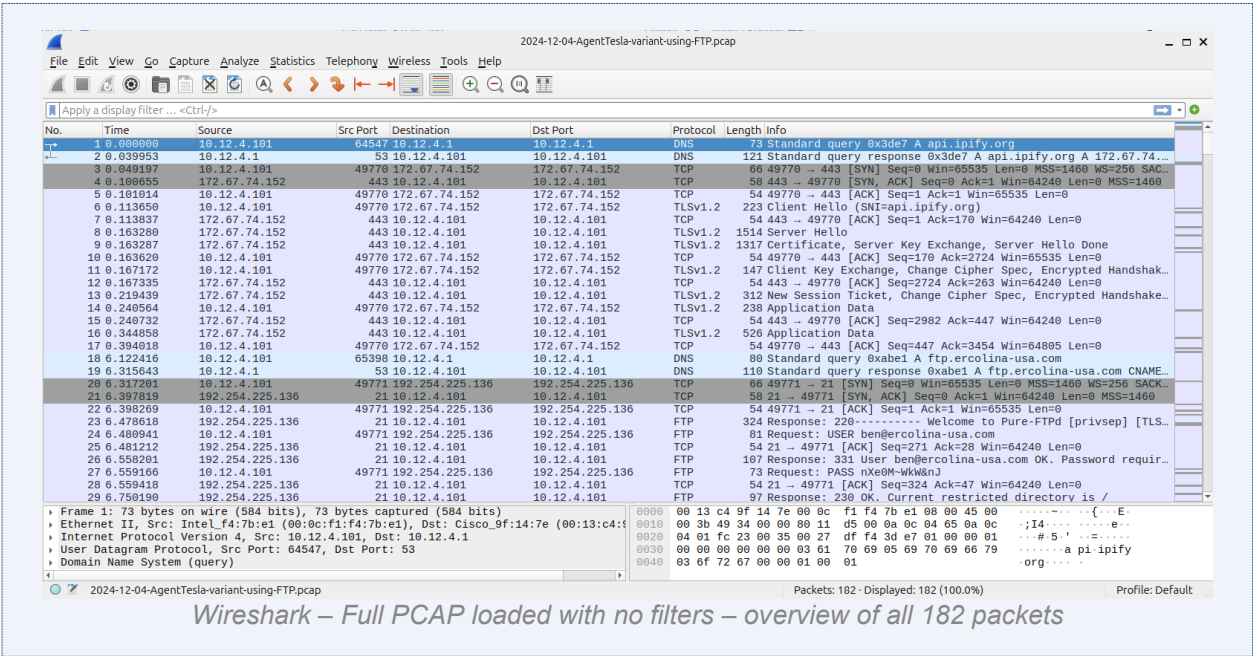
Analysis of the PCAP file captured on 4 December 2024 confirmed that host 10.12.4.101 was infected with AgentTesla malware. The malware queried api.ipify.org within the first second of execution to fingerprint the victim, then established FTP connections to attacker server 192.254.225.136 and successfully exfiltrated four files containing passwords, browser credentials, and keylogger data. A second FTP session approximately 20 minutes later confirmed persistent beaconing behavior.

1.1 Key Findings

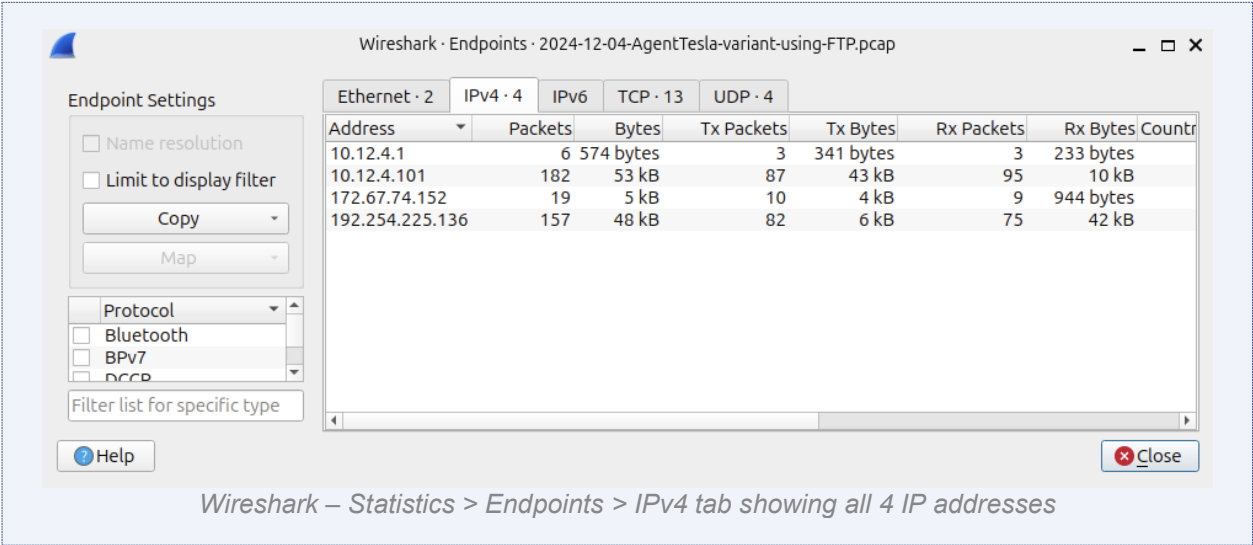
- Infected host confirmed as 10.12.4.101 – Windows user gary.strickman on DESKTOP-VJCRXEB
- First malware action at t=0.000000 was a DNS query for api.ipify.org – AgentTesla IP fingerprinting behaviour
- FTP connection to 192.254.225.136 (ftp.ercolina-usa.com) established within 6 seconds of execution
- FTP credentials transmitted in cleartext – USER ben@ercolina-usa.com / PASS nXe0M-WkW&nJ
- Four files exfiltrated: passwords, Chrome credentials, Edge credentials, and keylogger data
- Second FTP session at t=1211 seconds confirms persistent beaconing – 20 minutes after first session
- All 182 packets in the capture involve only 4 IP addresses – a focused, targeted attack

2. Infected Host Identification

Screenshot Evidence: Wireshark – Full PCAP loaded with no filters – overview of all 182 packets



Screenshot Evidence: Wireshark – Statistics > Endpoints > IPv4 tab showing all 4 IP addresses



2.1 Network Endpoints

IP Address	Packets	Bytes	Role
10.12.4.1	6	574 bytes	Internal DNS server / gateway
10.12.4.101	182	53 KB	INFECTED VICTIM HOST

IP Address	Packets	Bytes	Role
172.67.74.152	19	5 KB	api.ipify.org – external IP lookup service
192.254.225.136	157	48 KB	Attacker FTP exfiltration server

2.2 Infected Host Details

Victim IP:	10.12.4.101
MAC Address:	00:0c:f1:f4:7b:e1 (Intel NIC)
Windows Username:	gary.strickman
Windows Hostname:	DESKTOP-VJCRXEB
Internal Gateway:	10.12.4.1

10.12.4.101 is the source of every outbound connection in the capture. The Windows username and hostname were extracted directly from the exfiltrated filenames, which follow AgentTesla's standard naming convention of embedding victim system identity into each stolen data file.

2.3 First Signs of Compromise

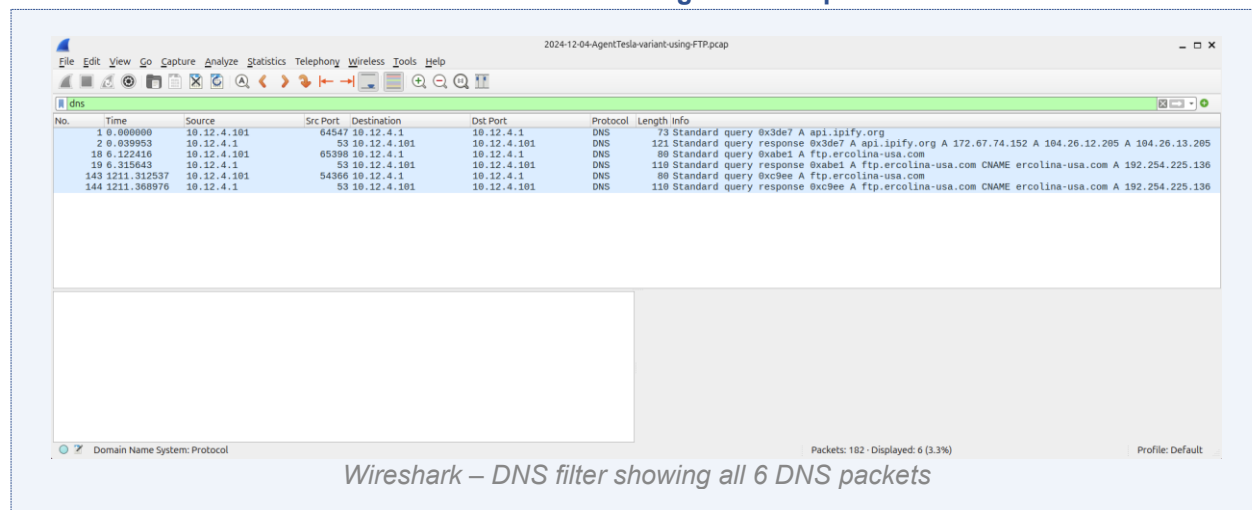
First Suspicious Packet: Packet 1 – t=0.000000

Event: DNS query for api.ipify.org from 10.12.4.101

The very first packet in the capture is a DNS query for api.ipify.org – a public IP address lookup service. This is a documented AgentTesla behavior. Immediately after execution, the malware determines the victim's external IP address. This packet marks the confirmed start of malware activity on host 10.12.4.101.

3. DNS Analysis

Screenshot Evidence: Wireshark – DNS filter showing all 6 DNS packets



3.1 DNS Queries – Complete Record

Packet	Domain Queried	Resolved IP	Timestamp
1	api.ipify.org	172.67.74.152	t=0.000000
18	ftp.ercolina-usa.com	(query)	t=6.122416
19	ftp.ercolina-usa.com	192.254.225.136 via CNAME ercolina-usa.com	t=6.315643
143	ftp.ercolina-usa.com	(query – 2nd session)	t=1211.312537
144	ftp.ercolina-usa.com	192.254.225.136 via CNAME ercolina-usa.com	t=1211.368976

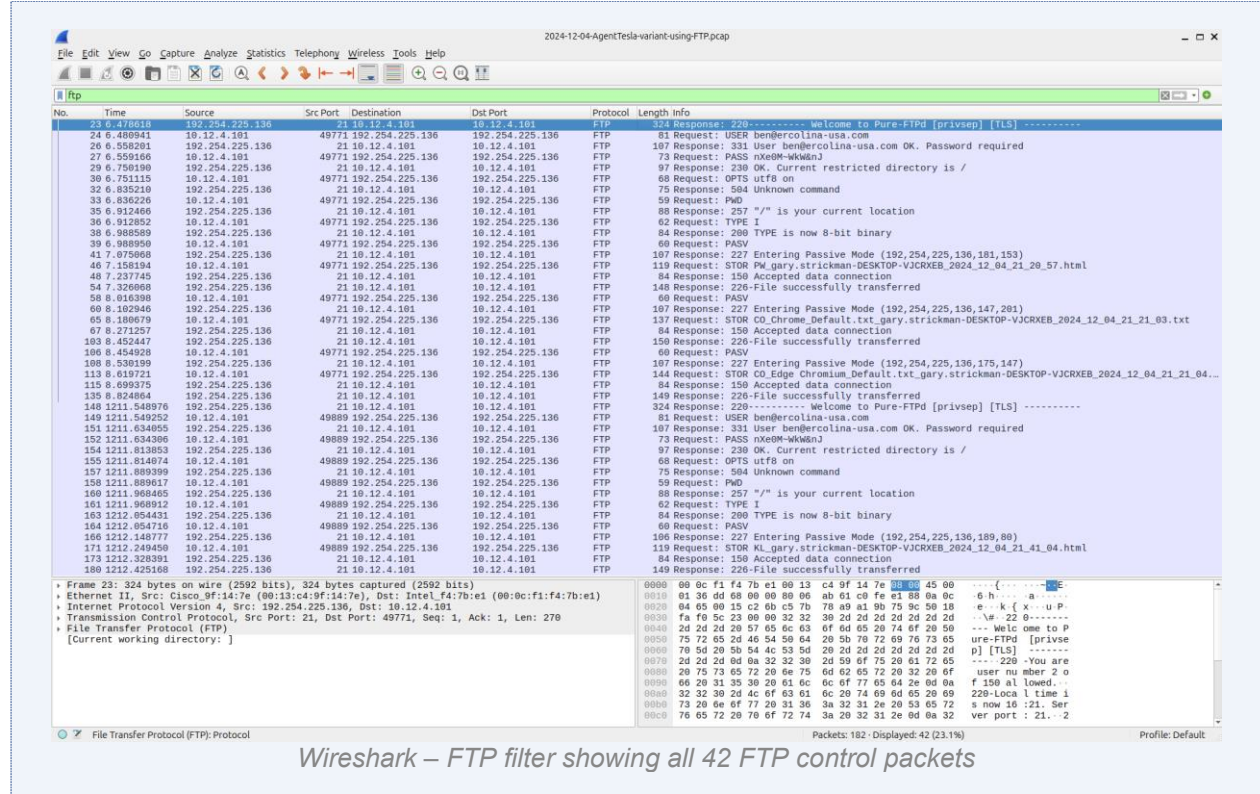
3.2 DNS Analysis Findings

- Only two domains queried in the entire capture – api.ipify.org and ftp.ercolina-usa.com, confirming a minimal and focused attack with no additional C2 infrastructure
- api.ipify.org at t=0 confirms AgentTesla's IP fingerprinting behavior as the first post-execution action
- ftp.ercolina-usa.com resolves via CNAME to ercolina-usa.com, pointing to 192.254.225.136 – CNAME adds a layer of infrastructure indirection
- Second DNS query for ftp.ercolina-usa.com at t=1211 seconds confirms persistent beaconing – malware reconnected approximately 20 minutes after the first session

4. FTP Traffic Analysis (Critical Section)

FTP transmits all data in cleartext, enabling full extraction of credentials and file names from the packet capture. The attacker's server was Pure-FTPd running on 192.254.225.136. Two separate FTP sessions were identified.

Screenshot Evidence: Wireshark – FTP filter showing all 42 FTP control packets



The screenshot displays a Wireshark capture of FTP traffic. The packet list on the left shows 42 FTP control packets. The packet details pane on the right shows the structure of a FILE command. The packet bytes pane at the bottom shows the raw data of the FILE command.

Wireshark – FTP filter showing all 42 FTP control packets

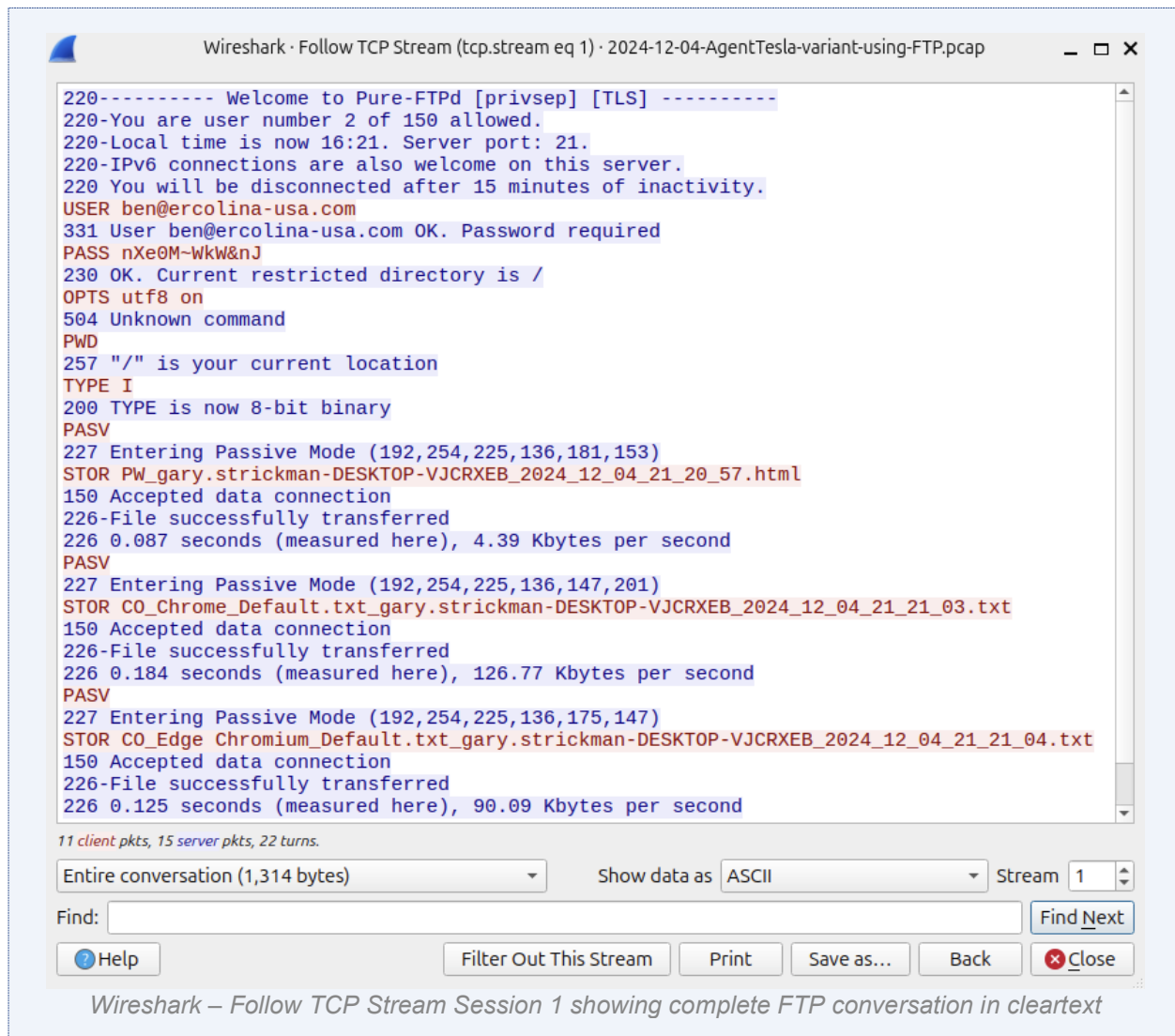
4.1 FTP Server Details

FTP Server IP:	192.254.225.136
FTP Domain:	ftp.ercolina-usa.com (CNAME ercolina-usa.com)
FTP Port:	21 (standard FTP control port)
Server Software:	Pure-FTPd [privsep] [TLS]
Max Users:	150 (victim connected as user number 2)
Session 1 Start:	Packet 20 – t=6.317201
Session 2 Start:	Packet 145 – t=1211.370119

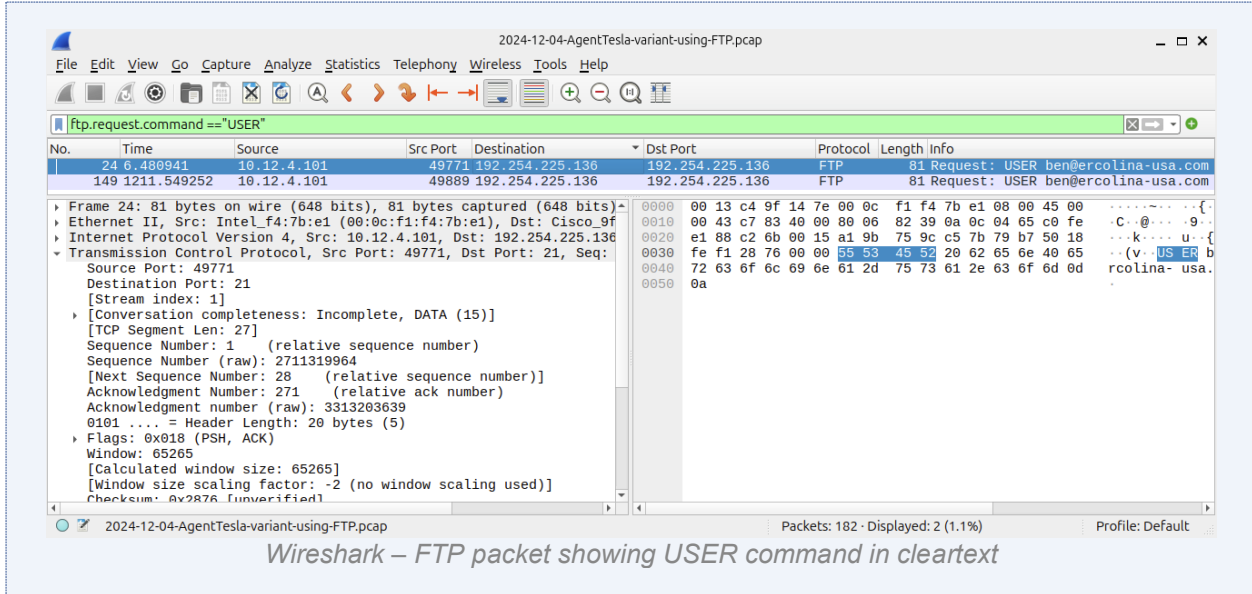
4.2 Stolen FTP Credentials – Cleartext

FTP Username:	ben@ercolina-usa.com
FTP Password:	nXe0M-WkW&nJ
Authentication Result:	230 OK – Login successful
Transmission:	Cleartext – fully visible in packet capture
Session 1 Packets:	Packet 24 (USER) and Packet 27 (PASS)
Session 2 Packets:	Packet 149 (USER) and Packet 152 (PASS)

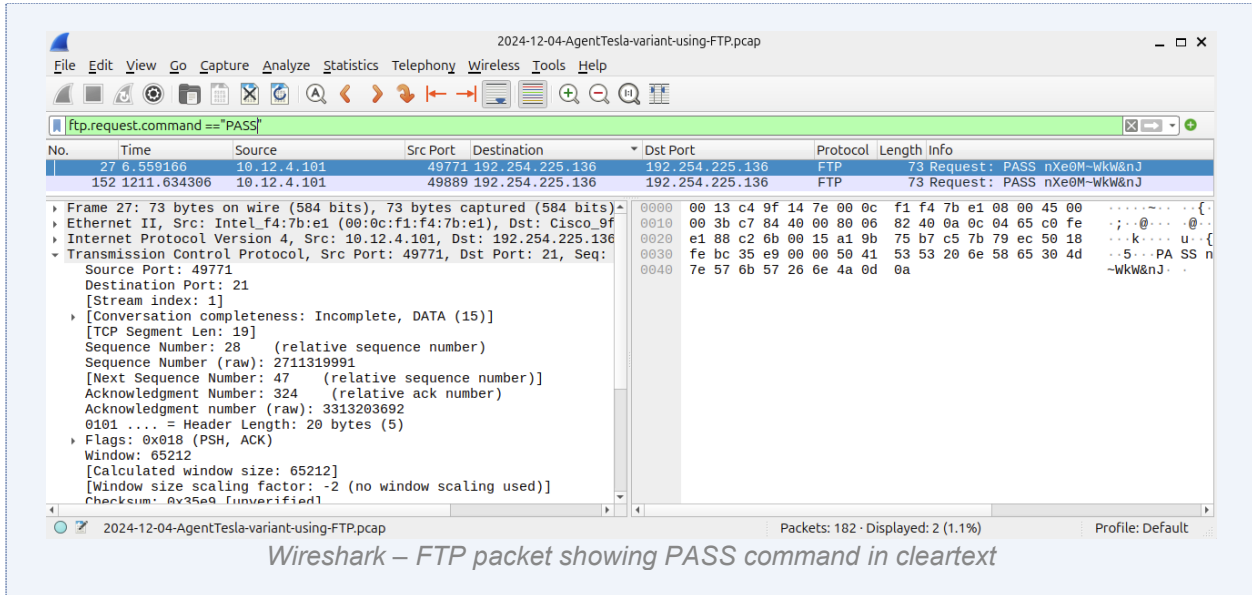
Screenshot Evidence: Wireshark – Follow TCP Stream Session 1 showing complete FTP conversation in cleartext



Screenshot Evidence: Wireshark – FTP packet showing USER command in cleartext



Screenshot Evidence: Wireshark – FTP packet showing PASS command in cleartext



4.3 Files Exfiltrated via FTP STOR Commands

#	Filename	Timestamp	Speed	Result
1	PW_gary.strickman-DESKTOP-VJCRXEB_2024_12_04_21_20_57.html	t=7.158194	4.39 KB/s	226 OK
2	CO_Chrome_Default.txt_gary.strickman-DESKTOP-VJCRXEB_2024_12_04_21_21_03.txt	t=8.180679	126.77 KB/s	226 OK

#	Filename	Timestamp	Speed	Result
3	CO_Edge_Chromium_Default.txt_gary.strickman-DESKTOP-VJCRXEB_2024_12_04_21_21_04.txt	t=8.619721	90.09 KB/s	226 OK
4	KL_gary.strickman-DESKTOP-VJCRXEB_2024_12_04_21_41_04.html	t=1212.249450	–	226 OK

Screenshot Evidence: Wireshark – FTP STOR commands visible showing all 4 exfiltrated filenames

The screenshot shows a Wireshark capture of an FTP session. The packet list on the left displays four STOR requests (Packets 137, 144, 145, and 146). The packet details pane on the right shows the structure of the first STOR request (Packet 137), including the file name and the data being transferred. The file name is PW_gary.strickman-DESKTOP-VJCRXEB_2024_12_04_21_21_04.txt. The packet bytes pane on the right shows the raw data of the first STOR request, which is the file content.

Wireshark – FTP STOR commands visible showing all 4 exfiltrated filenames

4.4 What Was Stolen – File Analysis

Prefix	File Type	Contents
PW_	HTML password dump	Harvested system and application passwords
CO_Chrome_	Chrome credential file	Google Chrome saved passwords, cookies, session tokens
CO_Edge_	Edge credential file	Microsoft Edge saved passwords, cookies, session tokens
KL_	HTML keylogger output	All keystrokes recorded by AgentTesla – collected over ~20 minutes

4.5 Data Transfer Patterns and Beaconing

- Session 1 began at t=6.317201 – within 6 seconds of malware execution
- Three files exfiltrated in rapid succession between t=7.1s and t=8.6s
- Chrome credentials transferred at 126.77 KB/s – largest file indicating substantial stored browser data
- Session 1 closed cleanly after all three files transferred
- Session 2 began at t=1211.370119 – exactly 20 minutes and 11 seconds after Session 1
- Session 2 used identical credentials confirming same attacker infrastructure
- Session 2 exfiltrated KL_ keylogger file – collected separately as keylogger data accumulates over time
- PASV passive mode used for all data transfers – victim machine initiated all outbound data connections

4.6 AgentTesla FTP Exfiltration — Confirmation

The FTP traffic conclusively confirms AgentTesla as the responsible malware. Evidence includes: cleartext FTP credentials, four exfiltrated files following AgentTesla's exact PW_, CO_, KL_ naming convention with victim username and hostname embedded, persistent reconnection after 20 minutes, and all traffic originating from the confirmed infected host 10.12.4.101. This matches AgentTesla's documented FTP exfiltration method precisely.

5. IOC Extraction – Phase 2 (Network-Based)

IOC Type	Value	Description
IP Address	10.12.4.101	Infected victim host – internal IP
MAC Address	00:0c:f1:f4:7b:e1	Infected host network adapter MAC
Hostname	DESKTOP-VJCRXEB	Infected host Windows hostname
Username	gary.strickman	Infected host Windows username
IP Address	192.254.225.136	Attacker FTP exfiltration server
Domain	ftp.ercolina-usa.com	Attacker FTP server domain (CNAME ercolina-usa.com)
Domain	api.ipify.org	IP fingerprint service – first malware network action
FTP Credential	ben@ercolina-usa.com	FTP username – transmitted in cleartext
FTP Credential	nXe0M-WkW&nJ	FTP password – transmitted in cleartext
Exfil File	PW_gary.strickman-DESKTOP-VJCRXEB_2024_12_04_21_20_57.html	Password dump
Exfil File	CO_Chrome_Default.txt_gary.strickman-DESKTOP-VJCRXEB_2024_12_04_21_21_03.txt	Chrome credentials
Exfil File	CO_Edge_Chromium_Default.txt_gary.strickman-DESKTOP-VJCRXEB_2024_12_04_21_21_04.txt	Edge credentials
Exfil File	KL_gary.strickman-DESKTOP-VJCRXEB_2024_12_04_21_41_04.html	Keylogger output

6. Full Attack Timeline

The following timeline reconstructs the complete attack sequence from initial email delivery through final data exfiltration, based on combined analysis of the phishing email and PCAP network evidence:

Screenshot Evidence: Wireshark – Full packet list sorted by time showing complete attack sequence

Wireshark – Full packet list sorted by time showing complete attack sequence

#	Source	Timestamp	Event
1	Email	12:51:16 UTC	Phishing email delivered – Subject: PURCHASE QUOTATION from sertan@acronas.com.tr (94.141.120.32)
2	User	Unknown	Victim gary.strickman opens email and extracts TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS.TAR attachment
3	Malware	Unknown	Victim executes TECHNICAL SPECIFICATIONS.exe – AgentTesla launches
4	DNS	t=0.000000	AgentTesla queries api.ipify.org – victim external IP fingerprinting
5	TLS	t=0.049–0.394	TLS connection to api.ipify.org (172.67.74.152) – IP retrieved
6	DNS	t=6.122416	AgentTesla queries ftp.ercolina-usa.com – resolves to 192.254.225.136
7	TCP	t=6.317201	TCP SYN to 192.254.225.136:21 – FTP connection initiated
8	FTP	t=6.478618	FTP banner received – Welcome to Pure-FTPD [privsep] [TLS]

#	Source	Timestamp	Event
9	FTP	t=6.480941	USER ben@ercolina-usa.com sent in cleartext
10	FTP	t=6.559166	PASS nXe0M-WkW&nJ sent in cleartext
11	FTP	t=6.750190	Login successful – 230 OK
12	FTP	t=7.158194	STOR PW_ password dump uploaded (4.39 KB/s)
13	FTP	t=8.180679	STOR CO_Chrome_ Chrome credentials uploaded (126.77 KB/s)
14	FTP	t=8.619721	STOR CO_Edge_ Edge credentials uploaded (90.09 KB/s)
15	TCP	t=8.700017	Session 1 FTP connection closed – FIN/ACK
16	DNS	t=1211.312537	Second DNS query for ftp.ercolina-usa.com – malware beacons back after ~20 minutes
17	TCP	t=1211.370119	Second TCP SYN to 192.254.225.136:21 – Session 2 initiated
18	FTP	t=1211.549252	Session 2 authentication – same credentials used
19	FTP	t=1212.249450	STOR KL_ keylogger data uploaded
20	FTP	t=1212.425168	226 OK – final transfer complete. All exfiltration done
21	TCP	t=1212.478147	Final packet – TCP ACK, capture ends

7. Conclusions and Recommendations

7.1 Conclusions

- Host 10.12.4.101 (gary.strickman / DESKTOP-VJCRXEB) was confirmed infected with AgentTesla malware on 4 December 2024
- Malware executed and immediately fingerprinted the victim's external IP via api.ipify.org
- FTP exfiltration to 192.254.225.136 began within 6 seconds of execution using cleartext credentials
- Four files were successfully stolen: system passwords, Chrome credentials, Edge credentials, and keylogger output
- Persistent beaconing confirmed – second FTP session 20 minutes after the first for additional keylogger data
- The complete attack chain from email delivery to data exfiltration has been reconstructed and evidenced

7.2 Immediate Actions Required

- Isolate 10.12.4.101 from the network immediately
- Reset all credentials for gary.strickman – Windows login, all Chrome and Edge saved passwords, all accounts accessible from that machine
- Block 192.254.225.136 and ftp.ercolina-usa.com at the perimeter firewall and DNS resolver
- Block 94.141.120.32 at the email gateway
- Submit all file hashes to EDR platform for organization-wide blocking

7.3 Analyst Declaration

This report was produced following independent forensic analysis of 2024-12-04-AgentTesla-variant-using-FTP.pcap using Wireshark. No malware was executed during this investigation. All findings are based on observable network artefacts.

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Date:	31 May 2026
Signature:	